

SCRUM LEADERSHIP SERIES

Product Ownership II: Learning Objectives

Twelve modules. Each module maps directly to one chapter of Product Ownership II: Making Hard Decisions. These objectives are used to demonstrate understanding for the Recognized Product Owner 2 credential.

The domain of practice and a Practice Partner are part of the learning.

These objectives are not met by recognizing the language or repeating an accepted explanation. The book and the course must be coupled with the learner's domain of practice, where actual conditions, constraints, and evidence give the objectives meaning.

Every learner works with a Practice Partner: another learner, a practitioner within the learner's domain, or a 3Back Expert Echo. For each significant objective, learners explain it in their own words, connect it to actual work, question one another's accounts, test assumptions and competing explanations, and identify the evidence that would support or challenge their conclusions.

The Practice Partner makes the learner's reasoning visible and correctable. The facilitator provides guidance and calibration, but cannot supply the learner's domain experience or establish professional capability for them. Capability develops through repeated judgment, action, and evidence in the work.

Learning approach: This document applies the learning model described in *How 3Back Approaches Learning*, 3Back, September 2026.

3back.com/papers/how-3back-approaches-learning

MODULE 01

Scrum Refresher

- 1.1 Distinguish a Team Product Owner from a Product Product Owner in this book's model.
- 1.2 Analyze Scrum as continuous flow interrupted by inspect-and-adapt Events.
- 1.3 Explain why the Team Captain is accountable for both deliverable and non-deliverable Results.
- 1.4 Decide what a Product Owner must still respect when the Team self-organizes the How.

MODULE 02

History, Values, and Principles

- 2.1 Explain empiricism through Transparency, Inspection, and Adaptation.
- 2.2 Interpret the Scrum Values as constraints on Product Ownership decisions.
- 2.3 Apply Lean principles to judge whether work is being pulled toward value or pushed as inventory.
- 2.4 Analyze how Agile Manifesto preferences show up in a live Product decision.
- 2.5 Compare Scrum with neighboring ways of working without treating them as the same thing.

MODULE 03

Product Ownership

- 3.1 Describe Product Ownership as people, responsibilities, and accountabilities spanning Stakeholders to Teams.
- 3.2 Distinguish Product Champion, Business Owner, and Team Captain as facets of Product Ownership.
- 3.3 Analyze how a Product Champion turns Stakeholder wishes into an ordered Product Backlog.
- 3.4 Explain how a Business Owner manages flow of work from Champions down to Teams.
- 3.5 Assess whether one person is playing more than one Product Ownership facet, and what that costs.
- 3.6 Map alignment from Product Champion through Business Owner to Team Captain.

MODULE 04

Leadership

- 4.1 Evaluate Product Owners as formal leaders who combine Manager and Director work.
- 4.2 Diagnose how a would-be Perfect Team Captain becomes a Bad Boss.
- 4.3 Select Autocratic, Participative, or Delegative style to match the decision.
- 4.4 Use Emergent Leadership instead of forcing every lead through the Team Captain.
- 4.5 Keep accountability for the decision even when the Team decides the How.

MODULE 05

Working With Stakeholders

- 5.1 Analyze who the real Stakeholders are for a Product Champion.
- 5.2 Distinguish a Stakeholder request from a commitment the Team Captain can accept.
- 5.3 Keep Stakeholders from directing Team Members around the Team Product Owner.
- 5.4 Negotiate gold-plating that sits outside already-agreed Acceptance Criteria.
- 5.5 Decide when a Stakeholder needs to be in Refinement and when they do not.
- 5.6 Build a working relationship that still leaves final say with Product Ownership.

MODULE 06

Being an Effective Team Captain

- 6.1 Define the Team Captain as the Team Product Owner focused on Now and Soon, not the Far Future.
- 6.2 Distinguish Team Spokesperson, Team Leader, and Squad Leader by how integrated they are with the Team.
- 6.3 Explain why a Spokesperson without accountability is not a Team Product Owner.
- 6.4 Analyze whether a Team Leader who never joins the DevTeam can still call the plays.
- 6.5 Assess what Value the Team is producing Now, Soon, and whether that Value is real.
- 6.6 Decide which kind of Team Captain the learner is actually being in their domain.

MODULE 07

Technical Debt and the Definition of Done

- 7.1 Separate Acceptance Criteria, the right thing, from Standard of Care, the right way.
- 7.2 Define Technical Debt as deficiencies that make the Product hard to change or deliver.
- 7.3 Analyze why rising Technical Debt lowers the Velocity a Product Owner cares about.
- 7.4 Explain Undone work as delayed Doneness that still belongs in the Development Strategy.
- 7.5 Convince Product Ownership that a Standard of Care is how value keeps moving, not gold-plating.
- 7.6 Put Technical Debt on the Backlog so Doneness stays a Product Ownership decision.

MODULE 08

Right-Sizing Stories

- 8.1 Explain Ready as understood well enough that the Team can get the Story to Done.
- 8.2 Run Example Mapping with Stakeholders and Developers to expose rules, examples, and questions.
- 8.3 Split Stories so each slice can still deliver value rather than a horizontal layer.
- 8.4 Analyze why a Story refined by one Team is Ready only for that Team.
- 8.5 Select a splitting strategy when a Story is still too big for one Sprint agreement.

MODULE 09

Making Hard Decisions

- 9.1 Explain Product Ownership as making decisions and staying accountable for them.
- 9.2 Distinguish the Value a Product Champion, Business Owner, and Team Captain each maximize.
- 9.3 Classify a Product decision as Simple, Complicated, Complex, or Chaotic.
- 9.4 Analyze why Business Owner work lives in Complex and Chaotic space, not on a mapped road.
- 9.5 Turn a failed Complicated plan into a Strategy instead of pretending the plan is still true.
- 9.6 Decide where Teams should dig next without promising treasure the landfill does not hold.

MODULE 10

From Idea to Strategy to Product

- 10.1 Trace work from Idea through Strategy and Vision into Product.
- 10.2 Evaluate a Product Vision as a draft that will change slower than the Backlog.
- 10.3 Design a Story Map that turns strategy into an Initial Backlog and a Release Plan.
- 10.4 Distinguish a Strategic Feature Backlog from a Tactical Work Backlog.
- 10.5 Recommend how Product Ownership facets get instantiated as an Idea becomes a Product.

MODULE 11

Scaling

- 11.1 Define Scaling as an Organization's response to increasing demand.
- 11.2 Analyze why adding Developers is a poor first move when Product Ownership is already confused.
- 11.3 Judge what happens to Product Champions and Business Owners when Teams split.
- 11.4 Distinguish scaling by growth from scaling by making the Teams you have more effective.
- 11.5 Assess whether a scaling method still leaves one Team Captain accountable on each Team.

MODULE 12

Velocity, Size, and Effort

- 12.1 Explain why Velocity, Size, and Effort sit outside the Scrum framework.
- 12.2 Analyze how Environmental Variables, including Technical Debt, make forecasts fragile.
- 12.3 Distinguish work that moves Velocity from work that produces Value without Velocity.
- 12.4 Use Velocity as information for Product Ownership, not as a contract for scope.

3Back delivers Product Ownership II. RPO2 is recognized by the Scrum Guide Organization. These objectives follow Product Ownership II: Making Hard Decisions by Dan Rawsthorne and Doug Shimp.